

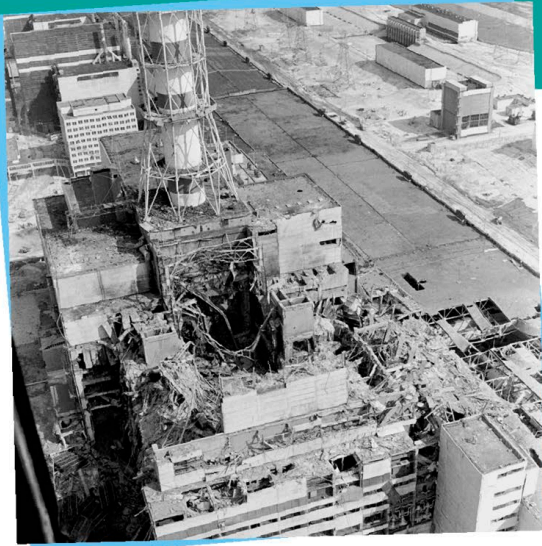
April

26

1986

Chernobyl nuclear disaster

During an accident at the Chernobyl nuclear power station in Ukraine, large amounts of radioactive material were spewed out into the atmosphere. The material spread and exposed millions of people to harmful nuclear radiation.



Born this day

1888 Anita Loos, US writer. A successful author, she was also the first female scriptwriter in Hollywood.

1918 Fanny Blankers-Koen, Dutch athlete. She won four golds at the 1948 Summer Olympics at the age of 30 while pregnant with her third child.

Democracy at last

After years of being governed by a regime that denied Black citizens even basic rights, South Africans of all races voted for a new government. Nelson Mandela was elected the first Black president.

1994

Also on this day

1803 More than 3,000 meteors rained down on the city of L'Aigle in France, finally convincing scientists that meteors came from space.

1989 One of the deadliest tornadoes in history struck the Manikganj district of Bangladesh, killing around 1,300 people and injuring 12,000.

2019 The Waorani people of Ecuador won a historic court case against the government to save their land from oil drilling.

